

ADD ONS TO TRY

**Advanced URL Shortener for Docs**

Allows users to shorten multiple long URLs in Google Docs with a simple click.

<http://dgit.in/URLshortener>

**HelloSign**

Allows users to import or create handwritten signatures and attach them to the documents.

<http://dgit.in/HelloSign>

**Speakd**

A handy accessibility tool that reads Google Docs out loud for users

<http://dgit.in/Speakd>

**Lucidchart Diagrams**

Allows users to create line art diagrams such as flow charts, mind maps, and more

<http://dgit.in/Lucidchart>

**Auto-Latex Equations**

Lets users insert algebra, trigonometry, and calculus equations in a Google Doc

<http://dgit.in/autolatex>

**Zoom**

Zoom's add on for Google Drive that lets users manage meetings in Gmail and Google Calendar

<http://dgit.in/Zoom>

**PULL OUT TEXT FROM IMAGES OR PDFS**

Having to re-type text from PDFs and images can be really cumbersome. If you want an easier method to pull out text from images and PDFs, Google Drive has you covered. The service is equipped with automatic optical character recognition, so you can get a document with all the text from the original file and have it ready to be formatted and used whenever you need it. To do this, head over to Google Drive on desktop and click the 'cog' (Settings) icon on the top right side of the page. Click on Settings, and check the box that says 'Convert uploads'. Now, you'll get a document with both the original file and the text from it, ready to be used when needed.

**CHAT WITH THE TEAM WHILE COLLABORATING**

Google Drive displays the document collaborators on the upper-right corner of

the page in a little bubble-like icon. This can be used to communicate with your team on the document itself by sending them a message that they can reply to (like an instant message). To do this, click the chat bubble and type your message. Do remember that this isn't a private message and everyone else on the document will be able to see your discussion.

**COLOUR CODE YOUR FILES**

If you want a particular folder to stand out or even organise

a group of similar folders together, you can colour-code your folders on Google Drive. To do this, simply right click on the folder you want to colourise. Now, click on 'Change Color' and select a colour from the provided menu. The folder icon will be coloured in your chosen shade and you will be able to spot it more easily.

**USE SHORTCUTS**

Google Drive has numerous keyboard shortcuts that allow users to navigate the service more quickly. However, it can be hard to remember all the shortcuts, so there's an easy way to find all the shortcuts that you can use. No matter what Drive app you're using, you can just type Ctrl + / to open the shortcut menu. Here, you will find shortcuts to format text, apply headings, insert links, add comments and much more.

**DO YOUR RESEARCH IN DOCS ITSELF**

When you're working on a research-intensive project and have limited screen real estate, you can do your research within Google Docs itself, instead of opening up a new tab for that. The research pane can be brought up by heading over to Tools

> Explore. Now, you will be shown some key topics that are present in your document and you can simply click on one to get search results for that particular topic. It works like a Google search page, so you'll get a 'web' tab and an 'image' tab. There's also a 'Drive' tab where you will find documents in your Drive that also speak about the topic you're researching.

Within the web tab, you can also insert a footnote citation in your document that links to the website used for research. You need to press the citation symbol next to the search result you want to add in the footnote.

**INSERT LINKS WITH SEARCH**

It's pretty straightforward to insert a link into Google Docs or Sheets. Simply, select the text, click the chain icon in the formatting toolbar or press Ctrl-K and paste the URL. However, if you don't already have a URL, Google can search for one for you since Drive has Google Search integrated. Just highlight the word and press the chain icon, below the bar where you can paste the URL, there will be some Google Search result URLs that you can hyperlink. If you don't like what's shown, you can even type in the bar and search for a link that's relevant.

**TRANSLATE DOCUMENTS**

If you've received a document in a foreign language and would like to translate it in a jiffy, Google Drive can easily do that. Upload the document to Google Drive and open it as a Google Doc. Now, click on Tools > Translate Document. Google will create a duplicate document in your preferred language.

Keyboard shortcuts		
Search keyboard shortcuts		
Text formatting	Menus	
Paragraph formatting	File menu	Alt+Shift+F or Alt+F
with objects	Edit menu	Alt+Shift+E or Alt+E
Editing	View menu	Alt+Shift+V or Alt+V
Navigation	Insert menu	Alt+Shift+I or Alt+I
Insert	Format menu	Alt+Shift+O or Alt+O
Comments	Tools menu	Alt+Shift+T or Alt+T
	Add-ons menu	Alt+Shift+A or Alt+A
	Count words	Ctrl+Shift+W
	Help menu	Alt+Shift+H or Alt+H
	Context menu	Ctrl+Shift+I, or Ctrl+Shift+I
	Comments	
	add comment	Ctrl+Shift+C

Access the shortcut menu anytime in Google Drive